

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

31 August 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

The Knowledge Paralegal role in A&O Shearman's Global Financial Markets group appeals to me because knowledge work in a finance practice sits at the intersection of legal research, document management and keeping a large team's work current and accurate. My background in legal research, document drafting and structured file management across dispute resolution and regulatory matters gives me a practical basis for that kind of work.

At BCLP I spent six months in the International Arbitration team, where I drafted procedural histories, amended sections of a Claimant's memorial and conducted legal research to support procedural submissions. When I became the only junior on the matter shortly before a significant deadline, I coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions across the team and helped ensure on-time submission. That required me to hold a large amount of procedural and factual detail accurately in mind while managing competing priorities, which is directly relevant to maintaining and updating knowledge resources in a busy practice group.

At Q-Legal I managed a data-privacy matter from instruction through to a formal written advice letter. I researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, identified compliance risks in the client's data-processing arrangements and translated the statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice. Writing for a non-specialist reader while remaining legally precise is something I have had to do consistently, both there and in my current role at Citizens Advice, where I regularly explain complex welfare and housing rules to clients in plain terms. The ability to communicate accurately without overcomplicating is something a knowledge function depends on, because the output needs to be usable by fee-earners quickly.

I am drawn to the Global Financial Markets group specifically because A&O Shearman's work in that area shapes market practice rather than simply responding to it. Working in a knowledge capacity within that environment would expose me to developments across finance practice at a level of depth and breadth I would not get elsewhere, and would develop skills in synthesising and communicating legal developments that I want to build at this stage of my career.

I would be glad to discuss the role further at your convenience.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva